Norway: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Norway is most exposed in downstream solar and downstream gas, where its Energy Security is higher than only 11% and 12% of the other economies scored. Its solar resource potential scores higher than only 5% of the other economies.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in upstream gas and upstream oil, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 97% and 96% of the other economies scored.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks downstream batteries 1st among Norway's own sectors, almost tied with upstream solar. Top data-based priority meets the most policy activity in upstream solar, upstream batteries, midstream solar, midstream batteries and downstream solar.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Finland highest for Norway, as an export market. Finland ranks 12th among Norway's trade partners; China ranks 2nd by trade but 41st on Partnership Strength.[1,2]

1. Energy security risks and why

9 of Norway's 29 placed sectors, those whose scores can be compared with other economies, sit in the two low-energy-security corners, Upgrade and Secure. Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs in a sector: its own production and reserves, its import needs and how concentrated world supply is.[1]

Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in downstream solar, downstream gas and midstream electric vehicles. In downstream solar it scores 0.41, higher than only 11% of the other 147 economies scored, which places it in the Upgrade corner. In downstream gas it scores 0.38, higher than 12% of the other 98, and in midstream electric vehicles 0.32, higher than 18% of the other 96; both sit in the Secure corner.[1]

Its high-priority sectors are the high-opportunity, low-energy-security sectors that the Strategic Index ranks highest. They include downstream solar, where reserves and investment pull the score down. On solar resource potential it scores higher than only 5% of the other economies, and on growth in investment higher than 22%.[1]

In downstream gas, energy access pulls the score down. Its gas consumption was 21.8 GJ per person in 2025, and on the change in consumption per person it scores higher than only 8% of the other economies. In midstream electric vehicles, foreign dependency and trade pull it down. The region it is grouped in made 0.7% of the world's electric vehicles in 2024, and Norway's trade deficit in these goods equalled 1.0% of GDP in 2023.[1,3,4,5]

For context, Norway imported USD 8.17 bn of midstream electric-vehicle goods in 2024; its largest suppliers were Germany (33.2%), China (18.3%) and Japan (9.0%).[2]

2. Economic opportunities and why

20 of its 29 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners. Economic Opportunity measures how well placed a country is to create value in a sector: exports, related capabilities, investment, costs, demand and technology readiness.[1]

Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in upstream gas, upstream oil and downstream green hydrogen, higher than 97%, 96% and 91% of the other economies scored in each. All sit in the Grow corner.[1]

In upstream gas and upstream oil, production and trade push the score up. Norway produced 4.34 EJ of gas and 2,050 kb/d of oil in 2025. Its share of world exports of upstream gas goods was 10.4% in 2023, and its exports of upstream oil goods were USD 54.7 bn in 2024. In downstream green hydrogen, consumption pushes it up: on expected growth in use per person it scores higher than 81% of the other economies.[1,3,5,6]

For context, its largest markets for upstream gas in 2024 were the United Kingdom (47.5%) and Belgium (23.3%).[2]

The paper's framework associates the Grow corner, high opportunity with high energy security, with building on strength (export promotion in RMI (2025)). In downstream geothermal, a high-priority sector in the Upgrade corner, its Economic Opportunity is higher than 86% of the other 102 economies. The framework associates that corner with building domestic capability (leapfrogging).[1]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by how strongly the data point to prioritising them, adding opportunity, security need, existing policy activity, the stage and the technology's low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it ranks downstream batteries 1st among Norway's own sectors at 0.66, almost tied with upstream solar (0.003 apart). Policy activity adds 0.200 to that score and security need 0.201.[1]

It ranks upstream solar 2nd, almost tied with upstream nuclear at 3rd (0.004 apart), and upstream wind 4th. Norway's allied pick, its first upstream or midstream sector on the Strategic Index after a resource-base screen, is upstream batteries, ranked 6th and almost tied with upstream electric grid (0.000 apart). The upstream sectors ranked above it are screened out because no resource base is recorded for them.[1,7]

To compare priorities with policy without counting policy in both, priority is read without the policy term, and both are split into thirds of Norway's sectors. Top priority meets the most policy activity in upstream solar, upstream batteries, midstream solar, midstream batteries and downstream solar. No top-priority sector falls among those with the least policy, and no bottom-priority sector among those with the most.[1]

The Climate Action Tracker rates Norway Almost Sufficient, as of December 2022. A stronger climate rating raises policy activity for low-emission technologies and lowers it for coal, oil and gas. Norway has 232 International Energy Agency Policies and Measures records, of which 150 name a technology. For context only, Global Trade Alert records 80 active industrial-policy measures for Norway: 30 tied to upstream electric grid, 0 to the allied pick.[8,9,10]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index scores how strong a partner is in energy supply chains: as a reliable supplier (Friendshore), as an export market (Partnership Opportunity) or, for middle- and lower-income partners,

through Development Potential. From Norway's viewpoint it rates Finland highest, as an export market, strongest in upstream gas, upstream oil, upstream solar, midstream nuclear and midstream coal.[1]

Germany ranks 2nd, as an export market; Sweden ranks 3rd and France 4th, each as a reliable supplier; Denmark ranks 5th, as an export market.[1]

Today's ties match this ranking in part. By average share across its energy-goods baskets, Germany is Norway's 1st trade partner, Sweden its 4th and Denmark its 10th; the index calls each a priority partner with strong ties today. Finland ranks 12th by trade and France 19th. Norway shares NATO and the Minerals Security Partnership with Finland, Germany, Sweden and France, and votes in the same bloc as each of them at the United Nations.[1,2,11,12]

China is Norway's 2nd trade partner but ranks 41st on Partnership Strength, as a development partner; Norway and China vote in opposite blocs.[1,2,12]

As a partner to the coalition, Norway ranks 19th of 192 economies, averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads upstream and midstream production across coalition members, its largest designed shares are 14.2% of upstream gas, 12.7% of upstream geothermal and 11.5% of upstream oil.[1,7]

5. Data notes and caveats

Values are as of 12 October 2026. Scores compare Norway with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Some of Norway's sectors are not placed: a score is compared with other economies only when the economy is sovereign and at most half of the score rests on filled-in data. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. Industrial-policy measures from the Global Trade Alert, New Industrial Policy Observatory, October 2026 extract (as of 5 October 2026) are context only, outside the Policy index. Country Insights shows the detail.

Sources

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Allied Industrial Base Explorer, Country Insights: Norway